Michael J. Darisse

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Citizenship: U.S.

Education

Ph.D. Economics, Florida State University	2027 (expected)
M.A. Economics, University of New Hampshire	2019
B.A. Economics, University of New Hampshire	2016

Research Interests

Economics of Education, Labor Economics, Public Economics, Economic History

References

Carl Kitchens
Charles and Joan Haworth Professor
Department of Economics
Florida State University
Email: ckitchens@fsu.edu

Luke P. Rodgers
Associate Professor
Department of Economics
Florida State University
Email: lprodgers@fsu.edu

Shawn Kantor
L. Charles Hilton Jr. Distinguished Professor
Department of Economics
Florida State University
Email: skantor@fsu.edu

Sean P. Corcoran
Professor of Public Policy and Education
Department of Leadership, Policy, and Organizations
Vanderbilt University
Email: sean.corcoran@vanderbilt.edu

Research

Job Market Paper

"The Impact of Exam Schools on Disadvantaged Students: Evidence from NYC's Discovery Program"

Abstract: This paper studies the New York City Department of Education's Discovery Program, an affirmative action policy implemented to increase access to some of New York City's most elite public high schools. The Discovery Program allocates reserve seats at New York City's exam schools to disadvantaged students who successfully complete the course requirements of a summer program. Using a regression discontinuity design and student-level administrative data I estimate the causal impact of exam school admission through the Discovery Program on educational outcomes. I find that while students experience an initial reduction in high school GPA, this negative effect does not persist into later years. Conversely, reserve seat offers increase performance on standardized math test scores. Under a counterfactual school assignment match with no reserve seats, I show that exam school displacement as a result of the Discovery Program has no effect on math scores, but boosts high school GPA. Taken together, these results suggest that the Discovery Program improves outcomes for disadvantaged students, with little to no cost for those displaced by reserve seats.

Work In Progress

"Retrenchment at the Blackboard: How Economic Crises Reshape the Teacher Labor Market" (with Zachary Gooch)

"Universal School Choice and Property Values" (with Carl Kitchens)

"Longer School Terms and Black Human Capital: Lessons from North Carolina's School Machinery Act"

Publications

"Teaching for Large-Scale Reproducibility Verification" (with Lars Vilhuber, Hyuk Harry Son, Meredith Welch, and David N. Wasser). 2022. *Journal of Statistics and Data Science Education*, 30(3): 274–281.

Experience

Research

Research Assistant, Florida State University — Fall 2024 - Present
Carl Kitchens and Luke P. Rodgers

Research Aide & Assistant Data Editor, Cornell University — Fall 2020 - Summer 2022
Lars Vilhuber, American Economic Association Data Editor

Research Assistant, Texas A&M University — Spring 2021 - Summer 2022
Ragan Petrie and Marco Castillo

Research Assistant, University of Virginia — Spring 2020 - Summer 2020
Vivian C. Wong and Peter M. Steiner

Research Assistant, University of New Hampshire — Spring 2019
Stephan Shipe

Other Employment

Operations Specialist, Brown Brothers Harriman & Co. — 2016 - 2018

Teaching

Florida State University

Instructor of Record

Analysis of Economic Data (Instructor Rating: 5/5)	Summer 2025
Analysis of Economic Data (Instructor Rating: 4.5/5)	Summer 2024

Teaching Assistant

Applied Econometrics (Master's)	Fall 2024, Fall 2025, Fall 2026
Econometrics II (PhD)	Spring 2024
Econometrics I (PhD)	Fall 2023
Introduction to Econometrics	Summer 2023
Intermediate Microeconomic Theory	Spring 2023

Seminars and Conferences

2026: Association for Public Policy & Management (APPAM) Annual Conference; University of New Hampshire

2025: Southern Economic Association (SEA) Annual Meeting; New York City Independent Budget Office; Association for Education Finance & Policy (AEFP) Annual Conference; Florida State University Quant Workshop;

2024: Florida State University Quant Workshop

Awards

Michael J. Piette Dissertation Fellowship, Florida State University 2026

Irvin & Peggy Sobel Award for Best Graduate Student, Florida State University 2025

Professional Service

Referee, Society for Research on Educational Effectiveness (SREE) Annual Conference 2026

Programming

Software: Stata, R

Other: Git, LaTeX, Unix Command Line

Last updated November 8, 2026.